Elevator Pitch

College Student Edition

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NEXT SALES

What is an “Elevator Pitch?”

DEFINITION:

A **brief**, **compelling** speech, typically **30-60 seconds** long, that succinctly **explains** a product, service, business idea, or **your professional self**. Its purpose is to **introduce**, **persuade**, **and capture the listener's interest**, often in networking, job interviews, or sales scenarios, with the **goal of sparking a conversation and a follow-up meeting or opportunity**.

“Elevator Pitches” are <u>not</u> one-size fits all…

MODIFY YOUR PITCH BASED ON SCENARIO:

- Interested in getting an internship/job
- Chatting with someone you are just getting to know

Personally, I don’t like them! Too sales-y!

“Good” Approach

Can also be used for *“Tell me about yourself.”*

Use 2-3 sentences (each) to talk about your...

PRESENT, **PAST**, and **FUTURE**

PRESENT

- ✓ Name
- ✓ Hometown
- ✓ Major
- ✓ University
- ✓ Etc.

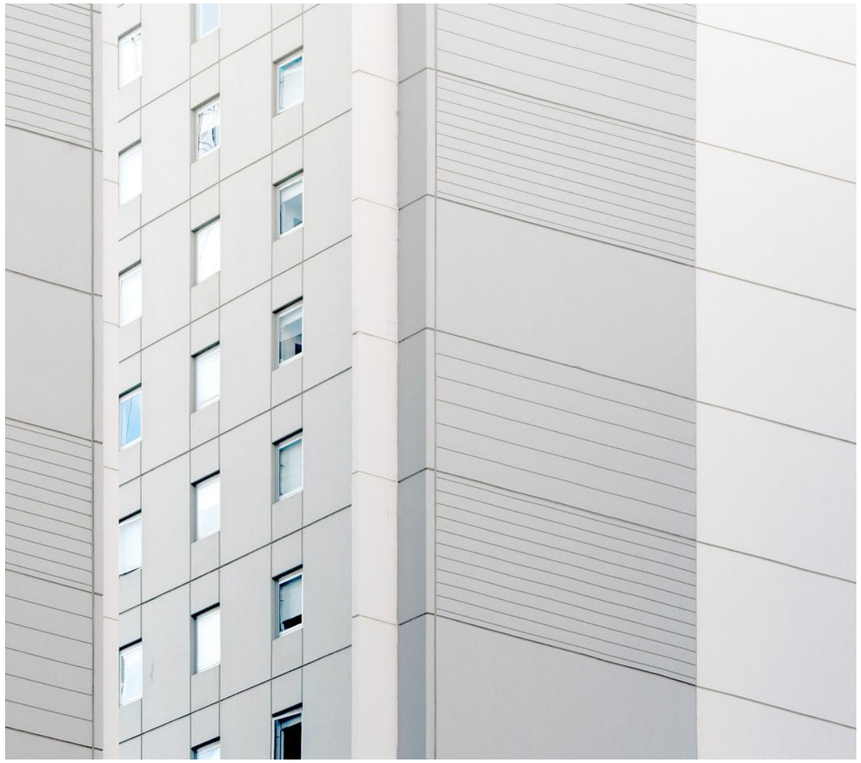
PAST

- ✓ Jobs or internships you’ve done
- ✓ Part of any relevant clubs on campus?
- ✓ Etc.

FUTURE

- ✓ What do you want to do in the future
- ✓ What your professional goals do you have
- ✓ Are you looking for an internship?
- ✓ Co-op?
- ✓ Full-time position?.

“Better” Approach

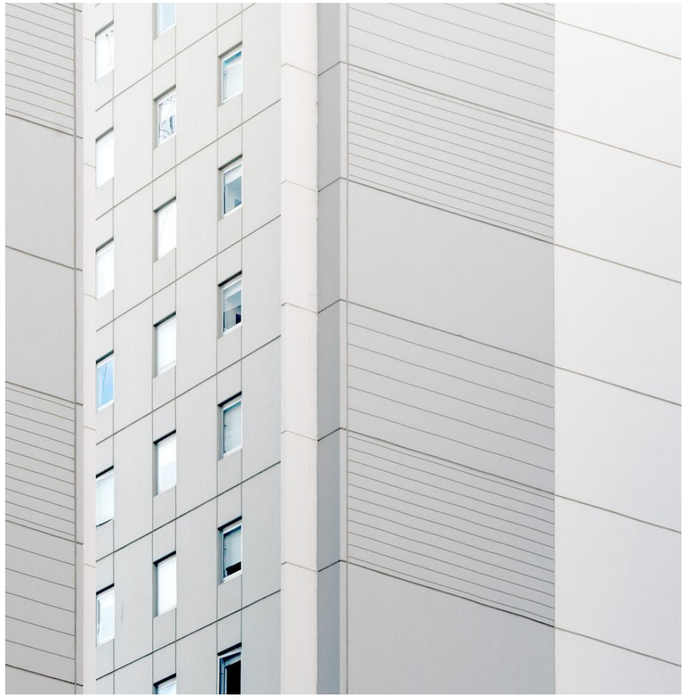


Briefly introduce yourself (and include a hook)

Start with a question!!
- “I’d love to get your thoughts on something…”
- “I’m curious what you think about something…”

A statement like this hooks the other person right from the beginning!!
- You’re telling them that you want to hear from THEM
- Now they have to engage and pay attention
- They can’t zone out or they will miss the context they need to provide their thoughts back to you

“Better” Approach



- Hi, I’m Jorge Selva– great to meet you.
- I’d love to get your quick thoughts on something.
- I’m currently a Junior at Xavier University, studying Marketing with a minor in Sales.

You’ve set the stage. Now **highlight YOUR UNIQUE VALUE.** (relevant experience, an accomplishment, or a shared interest with the person you’re speaking with.
BE MEMORABLE– lots of XU Marketing students.
Include something that makes you stand out!!!

- This past summer I did a summer internship working for 8451 as an Analyst.
- It was a great experience, but I learned that I no longer want to pursue a career as an analyst.
- I’ve become increasingly interested in a career in Sales, and have since added a Sales minor to my studies.

Now you’ve shared some of your unique experiences, and provided more context to the person I’m speaking with. Now a narrative is forming!! Now close with a question!!! **This keeps the conversation going**, and allow the opportunity for an “ask.”

- Given your position, what do you think are the most important areas to focus my studies going forward, and how can I best position myself for a sales position with a CPG company? ***OR***
- Do you have any suggestions for me on how I can increase my chances of landing a sales position with your company? ***OR***
- Do you have an example where you’ve pivoted in your career?

“Best” Approach

MAKING A PERSONAL CONNECTION should be your objective

- Don’t make the interaction all about you. People are more likely to engage with you if they have something to connect with you on.
- Your job is to come up with what that is
- FIND CONNECTION POINTS
  - Do your research on the person (if possible)
  - Whare are they from?
  - Sports! Competitive sports? Favorite sports teams?
  - Where did they study?
- It doesn’t always have to be about *you* to make it work.
- If you can’t do your research on the person (i.e. Career Fair), start with your intro (name, major, year in school, why interested in speaking to them about their company, etc.)
  - THEN ask them a question (“I would love to hear **how** you got started with XYZ Company, and **what** you love most about working there”)
  - Listen to their response, and look for connection points

Ask “**WHAT**” or “**HOW**” questions!
This generates a **story** from the person you’re speaking to, and keeps the conversation going.

Questions